

URED

Chapter – 1

1. Definition of Quran and various names of Quran.

Literal Meaning: Quran can be a proper noun or a derivative.

Imam Shafiee says Quran is a proper noun while others say it is a derivative.

Firstly, it can be derived from the root word qara'a (which means to read, to recite.) Qur'an is a verbal noun and hence, means the reading or recitation. We get this meaning from the usage of the Qur'an. Qur'an says:

“It is for us to collect and to recite it. But when we have recited it, then follow its recitation”.

On the basis of this meaning the Quran is called Quran, because it is most widely read book in the world. We read it in prayers, educational institute and many other places for different purposes.

Secondly, it can be derived from the root word qarana (meaning a union or conjunction.) Imam FakrAd Deen Razi quotes Imam Sufyan Souri as stating that the Quran was given its own special name, because letters are joined to make word, words are joined to make surahs and surahs are joined to make Quran.

Some scholars say, the Quran is named with this name, because it combines the substances of previous heavenly books, rather it combines all the branches of knowledge. In this regard Allah (SWT) says:

“Nothing have we omitted from the book”.

Thirdly, it can be derived from the root word Qara'in (which is the plural of Qarinah. It means evidence, argument etc.) In the Quran, we see that one verse interprets and gives arguments and evidences for another verse. So, Quran is called Quran.

Terminological Meaning: The speech of Allah, sent down upon the last Prophet Muhammad (SAW), through the angel Gabriel, in its precise meaning and precise wording, transmitted to us by numerous persons (tawatur) both verbally and in writing.

Various Names of the Holy Quran:

The holy Quran has many other names .From these names , some are original some are attributive. The both categories are mentioned in the below:

Original names of the Holy Quran:

- 1) اَلْكِتَاب -Al-Kitab-The Scripture
- 2) اَلْفُرْقَان -Al-Furqan-The Criterion
- 3) اَلذِّكْر -Ad-Dhikr-The Reminder
- 4) اَلْاَنْزِل -At-Tanzeel_The Revelation

Attributive names of the Holy Quran:

- 1) اَلْبُرْهَان -Al-Burhan-The Proof
- 2) اَلْحَكِيم -Al-Hakeem-The Judicious
- 3) اَلْمَجِيد -Al-Majeed-The Glorious
- 4) اَلْمُبِين -Al-Mubeen-The Perspicuous
- 5) اَلْعَظِيم -Al-Azeem-The Grand
- 6) اَلنُّور -An-Nur-The Light
- 7) اَلْمُهَيْمِن -Al-Muhaimin-The Guard
- 8) اَلْحَق -Al-Haq-The Truth
- 9) اَلْنَبَأ -An-Naba-The Message
- 10) اَلْبَلَاغ -Al-Balag- The Message
- 11) اَلْمَكْنُون -Al-Maknoon-The Well guarded
- 12) اَلْكَرِيم -Al-Kareem-The Honorable
- 13) اَلشِّفَاء -As-Shifaa-The Healing
- 14) اَلْبُشْرَى -Al-Bushraa-The Glad tidings
- 15) اَلْمُنْذِر -Al-Mundhir/An-Nadheer-The Warner
- 16) اَلْمُبَارَك -Al-Mubarak-The Blessed
- 17) اَلْهُدَى -Al-Hudaa-The Guidance
- 18) اَلرَّحْمَة -Ar-Rahmah-The Mercy
- 19) اَلْمُصَدِّق -Al-Musaddiq-The Confirming

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2. Characteristics of Quran.

It is the blessing of Allah (SWT) that He has made the Quran distinguished from other revealed and unrevealed books by a number of characteristics. Some of the characteristics are as follows:

1. Speech of Allah(SWT): The holy Quran is the speech of Allah in Arabic language. It is not the speech of Jibreel nor Mohammad (SAW). It was revealed to Prophet(SAW) through Jibreel over a period of Twenty-three years. Allah (SWT)says:

“And indeed, the Qur'an is the revelation of the Lord of the worlds. The Trustworthy Spirit has brought it down Upon your heart, [O Muhammad] - that you may be of the warners - In a clear Arabic language.”

2. Greatest Miracle: Allah has sent many prophets with miracles as proof of their prophet hood. Mohammad (SAW) was the last prophet, who was given many miracles and the Quran is the greatest of his miracles. These verses mention that the Quran itself is the miracle which is sufficient as miracle:

“But they say, ‘Why are not signs sent down to him from his Lord?’ Say, ‘The signs are only with Allah, and I am only a clear warner.’ And is it not sufficient for them that We revealed to you the Book which is recited to them? Indeed, in that is a mercy and reminder for a people who believe.”

3. Protected from change and alternation: The holy Quran will remain unchanged and protected from any sort of alternation unlike the previous heavenly books such as the Torah and the Gospel, which were changed and altered by the Jews and Christians. Allah Himself is the protector of this book. He says:

“Verily We: It is We Who have sent down the revelation and surely, We will guard it (from corruption).”

4. Free from contradiction: The holy Quran contains no contradictions, despite it having been revealed over a period of twenty-three years, in different circumstances, catering to different problems. The Quran challenges:

“Then do they not reflect upon the Qur'an? If it had been from [any] other than Allah, they would have found within it much contradiction.”

The lack of contradiction is a clear indication of divine origin.

5. Beyond produce and mimicry: No one will be able to produce and mimic a thing similar to Quran until the day of resurrection. Allah says:

“And if you are in doubt about what We have sent down upon Our Servant [Muhammad], then produce a surah the like thereof and call upon your witnesses other than Allah, if you should be truthful.”

6. Influential power: The holy Quran has an influential power on those who listen it. No person can remain unaffected after he has listened to it. The Quran itself describes its effect on listeners in many verses. Allah (SWT) says:

“And those who disbelieve say, ‘Do not listen to this Qur'an and speak noisily during [the recitation of] it that perhaps you will overcome.’”

7. Easy to memorize: There is not a single practicing Muslim on the face of earth except that he has memorized some portion of Quran. This is because of the ease and great emphasize laid by Islam on memorizing the holy Quran. From this verse, it is understood that the holy Quran has been made easy to recite, memorize and understand:

“And We have certainly made the Qur'an easy for remembrance, so is there any who will remember?”

8. A witness and dominant over other heavenly books: The holy Quran supersedes and overrules all other books revealed before it. This Book has

combined the virtues of the Books that preceded it and was endowed with more perfection than them. This is why Allah has made the Quran a witness, trustworthy and dominant above all of the previous Books. Allah says:

“And We have revealed to you, [O Muhammad], the Book in truth, confirming that which preceded it of the Scripture and as a criterion over it.”